PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL

BRITISH EMBASSY,
Washington, D.C.
8th April 1953.

J. 10310/4 (B)

My Dear Ros

An anonymous young lady from the local office of the Daily Express telephoned me this morning and said that she had been told that I might be able to help her with an enquiry received from their Head Office. They had been asked to find out the date on which this Embassy had been provided by the State Department with a copy of the Yoshida letter. She was ingenuous enough to add that the State Department had told her that a copy of this letter had been handed to me and that in these circumstances it was hard to understand why Mr. Eden had made such a fuss and had said that he had known nothing about the letter in advance.

2. I was able to reply quite truthfully that the text of the Yoshida letter had become available to us at the same time as it had become available to the press of the world. No copy of the letter had been given to this Embassy before that date.

3. I feel that I should let you know of this enquiry since I suspect that it was hardly prompted by a desire to spread sweetness and light.

Yours ever
Tommy

F. S. Tomlinson

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